

Segregated planning

By the 1920s, car ownership was soaring, radically altering the dynamic of towns and cities. The garden cities of the late 19th and early 20th centuries had integrated green open spaces, but insufficient provision for private vehicles; as cars proliferated, new city planners began zoning to meet motorists' needs. In 1929, the model town of Radburn in New Jersey followed England's garden cities, but was established specifically 'as a town for the motor age'. As shown opposite, it had paths, underpasses and bridges that segregated pedestrians from the traffic flow. This isolation continued with residential areas laid out in 'super blocks', incorporating networks of cul-de-sacs that provided peace and privacy. Because Radburn was built during the Depression, the ideas took a while to spread; but some were adopted early on by the CIAM (International Congresses of Modern Architecture), a group that applied social and urban planning issues to modern architecture. Segregated planning took off more widely around the world during the 1950s and 1960s.

